

Jidi Cao

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Research interests: Corporate finance, Corporate governance, Sustainability

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Last update: September 17, 2026

EDUCATION

Sept 2022 – Jun 2026	Sichuan University #11 in 2022 Best Chinese Universities Ranking by <i>Shanghai Ranking</i> PhD in Corporate Finance
Sept 2023 – Sept 2024	Technical University of Munich #22 in QS World University Rankings 2026 Visiting PhD Candidate in Finance ↔ Host: Prof. Sebastian Müller, CFA
Sept 2019 – May 2020	EDHEC Business School #7 in the European Business School Rankings 2022 by <i>Financial Times</i> MSc in International Accounting and Finance
Sept 2015 – Jun 2019	Sichuan Agricultural University Bachelor in Financial Accounting

WORKING PAPERS & PROJECTS

1. Silencing the Green Engine: How Shareholder Voice Suppresses Innovation. (*Job Market Paper*) [SSRN]

Advisor: Haiyue Liu

Using a large language model to classify environmental shareholder proposals, we find that proposals advancing to a public vote significantly suppress green innovation, an effect that strengthens with higher shareholder support. This is consistent with a multitask framework in which shareholder pressure weakens incentives for long-horizon environmental investment. Evidence from environmental compensation, incident coverage, and proposal content further reveals how incentives shift. Nevertheless, activism promotes innovation when targeting environmentally deficient firms, during periods of high climate concern, or under institutional sponsorship. Our findings highlight the unintended frictions of public ESG engagement in the absence of informed target selection and timing.

2. Words of (No-)Action: Regulatory Discretion and Shareholder Voice (*Work in Progress*)

With Christian Breitung and Sebastian Müller

We construct a dataset of over 5,300 SEC no-action letter filings containing multi-party correspondence on contested shareholder proposals. Using a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) framework and machine learning, we extract the competing arguments underlying each dispute case, predict screening results, and identify unexpected deviations from that benchmark. We then examine how case complexity, reviewer capacity, and staff-specific screening tendencies shape regulatory attention and outcomes, and study the consequences of screening for shareholder voice and market responses. The project offers a new view of no-action relief as a regulatory screening mechanism in corporate governance and provides timely evidence for debates over the SEC's stepping back in the shareholder proposal process.

REFERENCES

Roni Michaely

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Haiyue Liu

Advisor

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CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** Workshop on Corporate Governance in the Era of Climate Change (Guest speaker: Roni Michaely, HKU), Sichuan University, *Co-organizer* (Est. Chengdu, China)
- 2024** Swedish House of Finance and the European Corporate Governance Institute (ECGI) SHoF's Annual Conference on Corporate Governance, *Participant* (August 27–28, Stockholm, Sweden)
- 2024** The 2nd European Sustainable Finance PhD Workshop, *Participant* (June 18–29, Augsburg, Germany)
- 2024** ESG Risk Management Framework for the Financial Sector by SUERF, *Participant* (May 29, Vienna, Austria)
- 2023** Workshop on Current Research Trends in Sustainable Finance by TUM School of Management, *Poster presenter* (November 16–17, Heilbronn, Germany)

OTHER PAPERS & PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

1. Liu, H., Wang, Y., & **Cao, J.** (2025). Green credit policy and investment-financing maturity mismatch: evidence from China's green companies. *Environment, Development and Sustainability*, 1–24. (SCIE Q2, IF 4.2)
2. **Cao, J.**, Wang, Y., & Liu, H. (2024). Stock market reaction to new energy vehicle industry development plan: an event study in China. *Climate Policy*, 1–15. (SSCI Q1, IF 6.5)
3. Yang, X., Zou, A., **Cao, J.**, Lai, Y., & Zhang, J. (2023). Systemic risk prediction based on Savitzky-Golay smoothing and temporal convolutional networks. *Electronic Research Archive*, 31(5), 2667–2688. (SCIE Q1)
4. Yang, X., **Cao, J.**, Liu, Z., & Lai, Y. (2022). Environmental policy uncertainty and green innovation: A TVP-VAR-SV model approach. *Quantitative Finance and Economics*, 6(4), 604–621. (ESCI-indexed)
5. **Cao, J.**, Chen, X., Qiu, R., & Hou, S. (2021). Electric vehicle industry sustainable development with a stakeholder engagement system. *Technology in Society*, 67, 101771. (ABS2*, SSCI Q1, IF 10.1, Policy citation by the [Government of Argentina](#))

GRANTS & AWARDS

- 2023–24** State Scholarship Fund by China Scholarship Council (CSC) of Ministry of Education of the P.R. China (2023–2024)
- 2022–26** Doctoral student scholarship of Sichuan University

TEACHING

Sept 2024 – Jan 2025	Teaching Assistant Class: <i>Software Design Basic and Python Programming</i> Bachelor program of Business Administration at the Business School of Sichuan University
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OTHER EXPERIENCE

Aug 2020 – Feb 2021	Financial Analyst Finance and Payment Department, PingPong Europe S.A., Luxembourg • Initiated wire transfer, managed virtual accounts, and facilitated automation payment projects • Prepared PI/EMI legal reporting to Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier • Collaborated with compliance team in KYC and AML using Moody's RDC screening
Aug–Oct 2017	Field Researcher Governmental Field Survey, Aba Prefecture of China • On-site field surveys and independent evaluation of China's Targeted Poverty Alleviation Policy in underdeveloped areas

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages: English (Proficient), French (Basic), Mandarin Chinese (Native)

Certificates: Bloomberg Market Concepts, Certificate of Junior Accountant (Chinese)

Technical Skills: LLM fine-tuning, Text analysis, Web scraping, NLP, RAG

Databases: SEC EDGAR/Form 13F/No-action letter, ISS Shareholder Proposal/ECA, Refinitiv, Compustat, CRSP, FactSet Ownership, BoardEX, RepRisk

Programming: Stata, Python, L^AT_EX